

VER. 26.1

Authenticity

Tabards

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1. Implementation

The document has been created and approved by the General Assembly of 09.11.2024.
The document and its rules have been implemented since the 2025 season.

2. Definition

"**Tabard**" is a generic term used to describe the cloth worn upon the armor. It is made to show the heraldry of the wearer and prove your wealth and status on the battlefield, or in the list.
Nowadays, Tabards have the same function as a sports jersey: to indicate the team you belong to.

Type of Tabards:

- **Sleeveless Tabard**
  Tabards without sleeves. Simple design, common in the 13th century and 14th century. Tend to be rare in the 15th century.
- **Short-sleeves Tabard**
  Tabards with short sleeves that can go up to the elbow. Common design in the 14th century. Tend to be rare in the 15th century.
- **Long-sleeves Tabard**
  Tabards with long sleeves that cover the whole arms, from shoulder to hand. Common design in the 14th and the 15th century.
- **Eastern Tabard**
  We do not have many historical references for eastern Tabard. It is allowed to use the same Tabard as European armors. Eastern stylization of Tabard are displayed in the document "Eastern Armors".
- **Exception for full plates armors**
  Wearing full plates armor makes the use of Tabard not practical. Therefore, it is allowed to wear only a scarf. Scarves must follow the General Requirements (*see section 3 below*).

  Example of scarf:



Picture from The Medieval Things ©

3. General Requirements

3.1. Material Requirements

All Tabards and Scarves must respect the following requirements:

- Shapes, decorations and designs must be based on historical sources.
- Tabards must conform to the "*Textiles and Leather*" document.
- Tabards can be made of the following materials:
  - wool,
  - linen,
  - silk,
  - coton,
  - any other material based on historical sources.

- Tabards can be made of modern materials in the following cases:
  - the modern material replicates the aesthetic of an approved material listed above,
  - the modern material is strong enough to endure full contact fights and to not be damaged too easily,
  - we recommend asking for approval of the Authenticity Committee regarding Tabard made of modern materials before placing an order.

3.2. Fastening Systems Requirements

Tabards can be tied with the following systems:

- buttons made of fabric, wood, bone, or metal,
- laces, made of leather, rope or fabric,
- any other system based on historical sources,
- any modern fastening system is denied. (Zips, snap buttons, velcro, paracord, nylon rope etc.).

Tabards can be open on the side, tied with laces.

Tabards can be open on the front, and tied with buttons.

3.3. Colors Requirements

Colors used for Tabards must be based on historical sources. Any clearly modern color is denied. (Neon pink, fluorescent yellow, etc.)

For the Marshals' safety, the use of yellow as a main color of a Tabard is **Denied**. Yellow color must represent less than 50% of the Tabard colors. The combination of black and yellow must not be inspired by Marshal's uniforms.

3.4. Symbols and Decorations Requirements

Symbols and decorations used for Tabards must be based on historical sources. Any clearly modern symbol or decoration is denied. (Warhammer logo, movies or TV show imagery, modern slogan etc.)

We recommend taking inspiration from middle ages manuscripts to create your symbols.

Symbols and decorations used for Tabards must be made with the following techniques:

- embroidery,
- painting: can be by hand or by stamp,
- sewing a patchwork of clothes to create a design,
- any other techniques based on historical sources.

3.5. Exception for Cuirass

When wearing a Cuirass, it is allowed to wear the Tabard under it. In this case, it is also allowed to wear the pauldrons upon the Tabard.

Example:



Picture from Helli ©

4. Sleeveless Tabard

4.1. Historical Sources and Datation

Sleeveless Tabard is an easy way to display your heraldic. This type of Tabard has been used all along the Middle Ages, from knight templars to late 15th century armors.

They are **Approved** for **14th century**, **Transitional and** 15th **century armors**.



Life of Eustace and Other Saints - 1300 - France



Weltchronik - 1360 - Germany



Bibliothèque de Besançon - 1410 - France

4.2. Specific Requirements

Sleeveless Tabard must:

- follow the General Requirements (see Section 3 above),
- not be too long, Knee is the limit.

4.3. Examples of Approved Reproductions





Pictures from Age of Craft ©

4.4. Examples of Denied Reproductions

Yellow as a main color



Over long Tabard



5. Short-sleeves Tabard

5.1. Historical Sources and Datation

Short-sleeves Tabard is the main design of the 14th century and later. Its simple shape makes it easy to craft and to wear. Many different designs can be documented by historical sources

They are **Approved** for **14th century**, **Transitional** and **15th century armors**.



Bible historiale - 1360 - France



Weltchronik - 1360 - Germany



Office of the Feast of Corpus Christi - 1403 - Austria

5.2. Specific Requirements

Short-sleeves Tabard must:

- follow the General Requirements (see Section 3 above),
- not be too long, Knee is the limit,
- not have sleeves too long. Elbow is the limit, unless it can be documented by historical sources.
- have open or plain (as a shirt) sleeves.

Examples:

Open sleeve



Plain sleeve



5.3. Examples of Approved Reproductions





Pictures from Gohurt ©

6. Long-Sleeves Tabard

6.1. Historical Sources and Datation

Long-sleeves Tabard combine the role of exposing your heraldry and protecting your armor. The sleeves often cover the whole arm, up to the wrist, but can be shorter (up to mid-forearm). Many different designs can be documented by historical sources.

They are **Approved** for **14th century**, **Transitional** and **15th century armors**.



Guiron le Courtois - 1380 - France



Knebel von Katzenelnbogen - 1401 - Germany



Bible historiale, BL Royal 15 D III - 1420 - France



Le Livre et le vraye hystoire du bon roy Alixandre - 1420 - France

6.2. Specific Requirements

Long-sleeves Tabard must:

- follow the General Requirements (see Section 3 above),
- not be too long, Knee is the limit,
- cover the arm up to the middle of the forearm as a minimum,
- have plain (as a shirt) sleeves.

6.3. Examples of Approved Reproductions





6.4. Examples of Denied Reproductions

Yellow as the main colour



Pictures from The Medieval Things ©

7. Examples of Approved Designs and Decorations



8. Fastening Systems

8.1. Examples of Approved Systems

Metal buttons covered with fabric



Picture from S.Bier ©

Wood buttons



Picture from A. Labat ©

Laces



Picture from The Medieval Thing ©

8.2. Examples of Denied Systems

Velcro



Picture from The Medieval Thing ©

9. Changelog

Below, we will keep track of all the changes made over the lifetime of this document. This way, all our members can see how the documents are changing over time.

January - 2026 (V. 26.1)
Formatting redone for consistency and readability. Except points listed below, no content changes.
Add: “1. Implementation” (and subsequent modification of all Title numbers in the document)
Clarification:
- Split of “1. Definition and general requirements” in “2. Definition and description ” and “3. General Requirements”. **This split doesn’t have an impact on the content of the rules.**

Suppression:
- Titles “1.1 Definition” and “1.2 Types of Tabards” to harmonise with other documents. Content is unchanged.

December-2024: -Add
Document has been created